eight) with a fine piazza. The dungeons are dark and offensive. There is a new infirmary, with beds admitting only one patient in each. At my former visits here was a tap-room, which now, to the honour of the police, is abolished. At several visits in 1783 the prisoners were calm and quiet.

At the Grand-Châtelet, as well as the Conciergerie, the prisoners pay for their rooms according to their goodness; even those who lie on straw pay one sou a night. In this prison there are eight dungeons, which open into dark passages. In four of these dungeons (ten feet eight inches by six feet eight) I saw sixteen prisoners, two in irons, and all lying upon straw.[1]

L'Abbaye is a prison for the military or guards, and for such debtors as are men of rank. In the debtors' rooms a partition of lath and plaster, detached from the brick wall, answers the end of an expedient to prevent escapes: for if the smallest perforation be made in the partition, it is immediately discovered, by the mortar falling between that and the wall into the keeper's court, through the aperture which is left for that purpose. Here are six small dungeons, in which, as the gaoler said, there were sometimes fifty confined.

The Hôtel de la Force, a new prison for debtors (vagrants, deserters and petty offenders), has been occupied only from January 1782. It is an airy and spacious building, and has several courts and areas for the separation of men, and women, and the different kinds of prisoners. The courts are all clean and well supplied with water. The number of debtors was seventy-eight men and eleven women. Over their doors are painted the price to be paid for the beds from five to thirty sous a night. There are also rooms and beds for debtors that cannot pay: all the prisoners that are poor have one pound and a half of bread and soup every day.

Here are two chapels, an airy infirmary, for each sex; and a well furnished apothecary's shop, from which this, and the other prisons are supplied with drugs. Here are fourteen turnkeys, twelve every day on duty in separate departments; but in case of any riot or disorder they can readily assist one another: two walk in each of the men's courts. By the list sent into the office of the police, 17 May, 1783, the number of prisoners of all descriptions was two hundred and seventy-one, of whom many were deserters.

[1] The number of prisoners, 16 May, 1783, in the Grand Châtelet.

In rooms . . .	47
On straw . . .	209
In dungeons . .	16
In infirmaries . .	33
Total	305

I chose to visit the prisoners in the dungeons, on maigre days, because their allowance then being only bread, a little present of wine is the more acceptable.

The *arrêt* of Parliament of the 19th of February, 1782, for the regulation of this prison, containing twenty-nine articles, is ordered to be read in the chapels before all the prisoners on the first Sunday of every month, and to be fixed on the doors of the chapels, and on several other conspicuous parts of the prison.[1]

At the Hôtel-de-ville there are two rooms, in which were two men and a woman.

The Bicêtre is upon a small eminence about two miles from Paris. If it were only a prison, I should call it an enormous one; but this for men, like the Salpêtrière for women, is indeed a kind of general hospital. Of about four thousand men that are within its walls, not one-half are prisoners. The majority are: the poor, who wear a coarse brown uniform, and seem as miserable as the poor in some of our country workhouses; the insane; and those that have the venereal disease. Each sort is in a court and apartments totally separate from the other, and from criminals. Some are in little rooms about eight feet square, window three feet and a half by two feet, with a grate, but not many glazed: there is but one prisoner in a room. These pay two hundred livres a year for their board. The number of these rooms is two hundred and ninety-six. There are others in two large rooms called La Force, on the other side of the court (La Cour Royale) which were crowded with prisoners: in 1778, there were upwards of two hundred. Such a number confined together in idleness, must produce a great corruption of manners. Many at their unhappy end have ascribed their ruin to the flagitious examples they had here seen, and the instructions here given them.

In the middle of La Cour Royale are eight dreadful dungeons down sixteen steps: each about thirteen feet by nine: with two strong doors; three chains fastened to the wall; and a stone

[1] Most of the articles of this *arrêt* are similar to those in the excellent *arrêt* of 1717; but the eleventh article being new, I will copy it: "Les prisonniers ne paieront à l'avenir aucun droit d'entrée ni de sortie de la prison," i.e. Prisoners shall pay no fee at coming in or going out of the prison.